A-A-30151
July 24, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

PAD, ABDOMINAL (Sterile)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Commercial Item Description A-A-30108.

This commercial item description describes sterile abdominal pads for use as postoperative dressing or for support of such dressings.

Salient characteristics. Sterile abdominal pads shall be nontoxic and nonirritating and suitable for use as a postoperative drainage dressing to absorb wound drainage or to support such dressings. They shall be provided sterile. Each completed pad shall be folded parallel to either width or length direction and then sealed in a white sterilizable paper envelope prior to sterilization. Envelopes shall not be capable of resealing. Heat sealing or gluing shall be a continuous bond without skips. Ink used for labeling on the envelope must not bleed through to the product or be affected by the sterilization process. Envelope shall be designed to permit contents be aseptically removed or presented without contamination from nonsterile surfaces. Tabs shall be provided to facilitate opening. Abdominal pads shall absorb a minimum of 14 times its own weight in water when tested in accordance with the U.S.P. method for Purified Cotton. All absorbent type abdominal pads are constructed to permit strike-through of body fluids. Nonabsorbent backing abdominal pads are constructed to contain body fluids and prevent strike-through of the fluids.

Type I -All absorbent. This absorbent abdominal pad shall be constructed of innermost layers of creped cellulose completely enclosed by a uniform thickness layer of absorbent fibers, and wrapped with absorbent nonwoven fabric. The nonwoven fabric covering shall overlap at least 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) and shall be secured by a bland moisture resistant flexible adhesive

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to form a continuous bond along the entire length of the pad except for the cut ends. The minimum finished weight of the Size A pad shall be 8 grams. The minimum finished weight of the Size B pad shall be 13 grams.

Type II -All absorbent. This abdominal pad shall be constructed of a uniform thickness layer of macerated cellulosic pulp (fluff) wrapped with cellulosic tissue. The pad shall be wrapped with an outer layer of nonwoven fabric which shall be sealed around all four sides of the pad to contain the fluff. The fluff shall have an absorbency time of less than 15 seconds when tested in accordance with the method for Absorbent Cotton, U.S.P. The nonwoven fabric covering shall overlap at least 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) and shall be secured by a bland moisture resistant adhesive to form a continuous bond along the entire length of the pad. The minimum finished weight of the Size A pad shall be 8 grams. The minimum finished weight of the Size B pad shall be 13 grams.

Type III -Nonabsorbent backing. This nonabsorbent backing abdominal pad shall be constructed of a layer of bleached absorbent fibers backed by a layer of nonabsorbent cotton, and covered with nonwoven fabric. A layer of absorbent creped cellulose between the absorbent and nonabsorbent layers is permitted. A single ply cellulose sheet between the outside nonwoven fabric and the nonabsorbent layer is permitted. The absorbent sections used in these abdominal pads shall not be less than 25% by weight bleached absorbent fibers. The nonwoven fabric covering shall overlap at the backing side at least 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) and shall be secured by a bland moisture resistant adhesive to form a continuous bond along the entire length of the pad except the cut ends. The nonabsorbent side of the abdominal pad shall be permanently and legibly identified by the use of a commercially acceptable color, either adhesive or thread, firmly attached to the outer nonwoven fabric. The color shall not bleed or run when steam sterilized. The minimum finished weight of the Size C pad shall be 17 grams.

Type IV -Nonabsorbent backing. This nonabsorbent backing abdominal pad shall be constructed of a layer of bleached macerated cellulosic pulp (fluff) wrapped with absorbent cellulosic tissue, a backing of nonabsorbent fluorochemical treated nonwoven fabric,

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and the pads shall be completely wrapped with the nonwoven fabric and sealed around all four sides to contain the fluff. The absorbent layer of fluff shall have an absorbency time of less than 15 seconds when tested in accordance with the method for Absorbent Cotton, U.S.P. The nonwoven fabric covering shall overlap at the backing side by at least 1/2 inch (1.27 cm) and shall be secured by a bland moisture resistant flexible adhesive to form a continuous bond along the entire length of the pad. The nonabsorbent side of the abdominal pad shall be permanently and legibly identified by use of a commercially acceptable color, either adhesive or thread, firmly attached to the outer nonwoven fabric. The color shall not bleed or run when steam sterilized.

Nonwoven fabric. The nonwoven fabric shall be absorbent, white, nonwoven fabric which is all cotton, all rayon, a mixture of cotton and rayon plus a binder, or a rayon and polyester blend. The fabric shall have a nonwoven construction of adequate porosity to permit penetration of fluid and shall weight no less than 150 grains per square yard. The fabric shall be free of acid, alkali, starch or dyes. When tested in accordance with Absorbent Gauze, U.S.P., the water soluble substances of the fabric shall not exceed 0.75% and the ignited residue of the water extract shall not exceed 0.20%. The fatty matter shall not exceed 0.7% and ash not exceed 3.5%. The nonwoven fabrics shall be rapid wicking and shall be capable of preventing linting of inner contents.

Absorbent fibers. The absorbent fibers shall be fully bleached, white, and substantially free from lumps, oil spots, dirt and other foreign material. Fibers shall absorb no less than 16 times its weight of water and shall completely submerge in 15 seconds when tested in accordance with Purified Cotton, USP. Absorbent fibers shall meet Purified Cotton, USP, requirements for alkalinity, acidity and dyes. Water soluble substances shall not exceed 1%, and the ash shall not exceed 2%. Absorbent fibers shall be made from purified new or reworked cotton (i.e. combers or cardstrip); or cotton linters; or rayon; or cotton or rayon reworked from clean yarn threads or fabric; or mixtures of these types. Fibers may also be made of mixture of bleached rayon, polyester and cotton.

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Absorbent creped cellulose. Absorbent creped cellulose shall consist of fully bleached chemical pulp cellulose that will absorb at least 16 times its weight in water and will completely submerge in 15 seconds. Six plies of 11 pound basis weight cellulose or three plies of 25 pound basis weight cellulose (24 by 36, 500 sheets) is acceptable.

Absorbent macerated cellulosic pulp fluff. Shall be absorbent, bleached macerated cellulosic pulp (fluff) having an absorbency time of less than 15 seconds and shall absorb not less than 16 times its weight of water when tested in accordance with Absorbent Cotton, USP.

Nonabsorbent nonwoven fabric. Shall be a layer of nonabsorbent fluorochemically treated nonwoven fabric.

Nonabsorbent cotton (backing). Nonabsorbent cotton shall be bleached or unbleached and made from new or reworked cotton or cotton fibers that has been reworked from clean yarn, threads or fabric, or blend of these types. The mixture shall contain no more than 50% cotton linters.

Sizes of the unfolded abdominal pad are approximate on the width measurement (+ or - 1/4 inch (0.635 cm)), and on the length measurement (+ or - 1/2 inch (1.27 cm)). For maximum protection of the sterilized abdominal pad, a number of pads are placed in a full length chipboard (or similar) tray, and a number of trays are then placed in a case which is the unit of issue.

Size A. 5 inches wide x 9 inches long (12.70 cm wide x 22.86 cm long). Case of 400 pads (25/tray, 16 trays/case).

Size B. 7-1/2 inches wide x 8 inches long (19.05 cm wide x 20.32 cm long). Case of 240 pads (20/tray, 12 trays/case or 15/tray, 16 trays/case).

Size C. 8 inches wide x 10 inches long (20.32 cm wide x 25.40 cm long). Case of 360 pads (20/tray, 18 trays/case).

Each envelope shall have minimal marking that the product is sterile and a legend such as "Sterility guaranteed unless envelope is damaged or open". Each envelope of nonabsorbent backing abdominal pads shall have instructions about which side of the pad is applied to the wound.

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Workmanship. Abdominal pads shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Case (CS). One case containing the number of sterile abdominal pads stated in salient characteristics constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item. Testing and examination shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Test methods shall be suitable, accurate, and reproducible.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with this commercial item description requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and inspection level II. The unit or product for examination purposes shall be one sterile abdominal pad and all items listed in salient characteristics will be subject to examination.

Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereafter. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

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Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to the degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from the receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be that usually provided by the supplier as commercial practice, and as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

6510-00-775-5706	(Type I or Type II, Size B)
6510-00-814-3535	(Type I, Size A)
6510-00-450-3474	(Type I, Size B)
6510-00-107-0881	(Type III, Size C)

Copies of Federal Standard No. 376, Preferred Metric Units for General Use by the Federal Government and MIL-STD-105, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes, may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20420.

Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
(b) Type and size.

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

DoD-MB

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

VA-OSS VAMKC (904)
Agent VA-OSS VACO (92A)

AGENT:

DLA-DM

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

Project No. 6510-0801

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